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Secret Message to Comrades in India

[On May 20, 1941, Netaji sent this message from Berlin telegraphically to 'Rahamat Khan' through the Italian Legation in Kabul; this was among the documents collected by Sarat Chandra Bose during his visit to Europe in 1948-49.—Ed.]

"BIG events will happen soon in sphere of international politics which will help the overthrow of British Imperialism. Time is therefore ripe for widespread propaganda and activity against Britain throughout the world and particularly in Oriental countries. To this work Indians can contribute much but they must speak and act in the name of Free India. I am expecting from the Axis Powers within a fortnight an open declaration regarding Indian Independence. Immediately after this declaration I intend starting propaganda and activity, including radio propaganda, in name of Free India Movement. I expect Axis declaration to say that the constitution of the Free Indian State will be decided by the Indian people themselves. My propaganda also will avoid party questions and simply appeal to the Indian people to fight for their liberty and take the help of all friendly powers. In my opinion the good results that will follow from my open propaganda in India will far outweigh the bad results, if any. If you have any serious objections to my starting open propaganda even after the Axis declaration regarding Indian Independence then please return to India, consult friends and come back to Kabul and report to me. It is particularly necessary to consult Sarat Bose in Calcutta on this point. If however you agree that I should start propaganda after the Axis Declaration then let me know at once.

Please let me know names of important men you met in India. Have you delivered to Sarat Bose the personal letters and the long article? Has the party published my statement on why I left India which I sent with you? Did you meet the Moulana at Adda Sahib